



INTERNAL BUSINESS CASE

The business case for modern B2B ordering

Prepared for wholesale, distribution, and manufacturing teams evaluating how their buyers place orders.

For companies with \$15–300M in revenue and high-volume wholesale ordering

2026 edition

Why this is on the agenda now

B2B purchasing has moved online while overall B2B trade has stayed flat. The growth is not in more buyers — it is in a larger share of the same buyers ordering digitally, and choosing suppliers by how easy that is.

\$2.93T U.S. B2B ecommerce in 2025, up 13% while total B2B sales stayed roughly flat	39% of B2B buyers will place orders above \$500K through digital self-service — up from 28% two years earlier
94% of smartphone time is spent inside apps rather than a browser	>40% of revenue at leading B2B organizations is driven or influenced by mobile

The practical consequence: the ordering experience is no longer a back-office system. It is the surface your customers judge you on, and the point at which they decide whether to reorder or call somebody else.

What the current setup usually costs

Most mid-market wholesalers are running one of three things: an aging ERP portal, a general-purpose ecommerce platform bent into B2B shape, or phone-and-email order entry. Each carries a cost that rarely appears as a line item.

Catalog performance	Platforms built for consumer retail slow down at wholesale catalog sizes. Buyers abandon search and call a rep, which converts a self-service order into a staffed one.
Per-seat licensing	Charging per user means the warehouse team, the field reps, and the customer's own staff are rationed. The people who would use the system most are the ones left out.
Percentage-of-GMV fees	Fees tied to order volume mean your platform cost rises exactly as you succeed. Growth is taxed rather than supported.
Implementation drag	Mid-market B2B builds on general platforms commonly run four to eight months or more before launch, with integration work billed throughout.
Manual catalog upkeep	Product data maintained by hand across PDFs, spreadsheets, and the ERP consumes staff time continuously and still drifts out of date.

What RocketX changes

Unlimited SKUs, sub-second search

Whether the catalogue runs to eight hundred SKUs or eight million, filter and order in milliseconds — and never pay by the SKU. Performance other platforms do not match at scale.

Unlimited seats and users

Every employee, rep, and authorised customer gets full access. No per-user fees, no per-SKU fees, no rationing.

Customer-specific pricing

Each buyer sees their negotiated prices, volume breaks, and contract terms automatically.

Order directly from PDFs

AI reads existing brochures and catalogs so buyers order straight from them — no re-keying.

Native iOS and Android apps

Purpose-built for B2B ordering, not a wrapped website. Full catalog in the buyer's pocket.

Real-time cart collaboration

Multiple team members work the same cart at once, with every action logged — who, what, when.

Live inventory across warehouses

Real-time stock and availability, so buyers stop ordering what cannot ship.

Deep ERP and CRM integration

RocketX sits in front of your ERP rather than replacing it. Products, customer-specific pricing and live stock flow out of NetSuite, SAP, Microsoft Dynamics or Epicor; carts, orders and approvals flow back. Standard connectors are included in every plan.

Why the native app matters commercially

A responsive website and a native app are not the same product. For repeat wholesale ordering the difference shows up directly in order frequency.

Reordering is a habit, not a search

Most B2B orders are repeat orders. A browser makes the buyer find a bookmark, load a site, and log in every time. An app is one tap, already signed in — friction removed from every reorder for the life of the account.

A permanent position on the buyer's phone

Your icon sits on the home screen. Competitors have to be searched for and rediscovered.

Push reaches buyers that email does not

Back-in-stock alerts, contract renewals, and reorder reminders arrive directly. Users who opt into push retain at two to three times the rate of those who do not.

The work happens away from a desk

Buyers order from warehouse aisles, loading docks, and trade-show floors. Native camera access means barcode scanning and reorder from a shelf label.

It survives losing signal

Steel-walled warehouses and rural routes kill reception. The catalog, pricing, and cart stay local and sync when the connection returns.

Where the order is actually lost

Most evaluations compare catalogues and checkout. The money leaks somewhere less visible: in the cart, between the moment a buyer starts an order and the moment somebody submits it.

A half-built order is invisible	On most platforms nobody on your side can see a cart until it becomes an order. A stalled cart looks exactly like no cart at all, so the first time you learn it existed is when it never arrives.
Carts die with the session	Browser carts are tied to a device and a session. A buyer interrupted on the warehouse floor comes back to an empty basket and rebuilds it by phone, or does not bother.
One person builds what six to ten people decide	Gartner puts a complex B2B purchase in the hands of six to ten people. When only one of them can touch the cart, the order is assembled by email and retyped, and it arrives incomplete.
The duplicate nobody caught becomes a return	When colleagues at the same account cannot see each other's orders, the same SKU gets ordered twice. That is the most expensive kind of transaction you can create.
What RocketX does instead	Carts persist server-side and sync live across the web shop and the native apps. Your reps see live customer carts, including what has stalled, and can act before it goes cold. The whole buying team edits one cart with every change attributed. And the cart flags a SKU the account already bought recently, before the order is placed.

How to size this for your business

No two distributors leak value in the same proportions, so the honest version of this page is a worksheet rather than a promise. Substitute your own figures; the arithmetic is deliberately simple.

Carts recovered

Carts started each month $\times$ share abandoned $\times$ average order value $\times$ the share your reps now rescue because they can finally see them.

Returns avoided

Returns each month $\times$ the share caused by a duplicate or wrong item $\times$ your fully loaded cost per return. Count the labour: a single return consumes the handling of eight to ten normal orders.

Rep hours redeployed

Reps $\times$ hours each week spent taking and re-keying orders $\times$ loaded hourly cost $\times$ 52. Every hour moved out of order entry is an hour available for selling.

Order size

Average order value $\times$ the uplift you expect from the full catalogue being searchable in seconds, unlimited seats, and reorder from any device.

Against those four, set the platform fee and the implementation effort from your proposal. If the first two alone do not clear the cost, the case does not need the other two.

How the commercial terms reduce risk

The structure of the agreement is designed so the platform proves itself before it costs anything. No figures are quoted here — current pricing is on the website and in your proposal.

Flat fee, never a percentage of GMV

Platform cost does not rise because your order volume did. Growth is not taxed.

Unlimited SKUs and seats included

Nothing is metered. No per-user or per-SKU pricing to negotiate, or to ration as the catalogue and the team grow.

Setup and integration fee waived on annual plans

The implementation cost that usually front-loads these projects is removed.

Billing starts at go-live, not at signature

You pay nothing until the platform is live and delivering value.

30–45 day pilot with joint ROI review

A defined evaluation window with agreed measures, before a longer commitment.

Native apps and standard integrations included

Not sold as add-on modules on top of a base licence.

What implementation looks like

01 1. Stack audit

We map the existing catalog, pricing rules, ERP, and order flow, and identify what has to move and what stays.

02 2. Integration

Two-way sync is built against your ERP and CRM. Standard connectors cover the major systems; anything beyond standard scope is quoted as a defined block of work.

03 3. Catalog ingestion

Existing PDFs, brochures, and product data are read in. No manual re-keying of the catalog.

04 4. Pilot

A 30–45 day live pilot with a defined buyer group and agreed success measures.

05 5. Go-live and review

Full rollout, with a joint ROI review against the measures agreed at pilot.

Questions worth asking any vendor

- ? Does the platform fee change as our order volume grows?
- ? Can our reps see a customer's cart before it becomes an order?
- ? Does a cart survive a closed browser, a flat battery, a change of device?
- ? Can several people at the same customer build one order together?
- ? Will the system warn us when the same SKU was already ordered recently?
- ? Are field reps and our customers' staff charged as seats?
- ? What is the search response time at our actual catalog size, not a demo catalog?
- ? Are the mobile apps native, or a website in an app shell?
- ? Does the catalog work when a buyer has no signal?
- ? When does billing start — at signature or at go-live?
- ? What happens to our data and integrations if we leave?

Next step

A personalised demo against your own catalog, a short stack audit, and a low-risk pilot with measurable results within weeks.

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SOURCES

Digital Commerce 360 / U.S. Department of Commerce for B2B ecommerce totals and growth. Baymard Institute for the cart-abandonment rate, averaged across 50 studies (2006-2025); that figure covers all ecommerce and is not segmented for B2B. Gartner for the size of the buying group on a complex B2B purchase. Return-handling effort per the B2B E-commerce Association's distribution benchmarks. McKinsey B2B Pulse, ninth annual survey of 3,942 B2B decision makers across 13 countries, for digital order values. Sensor Tower, State of Mobile 2026, for share of smartphone time outside the browser; this figure covers all smartphone use, not B2B ordering specifically. Boston Consulting Group with Google, "Mobile Marketing and the New B2B Buyer" (2017), for mobile's share of B2B revenue. Airship retention benchmarks for push opt-in. Implementation timelines reflect 2026 market benchmarks for mid-market B2B builds and vary by scope.